August 24, 2026

The City Council of the City of Sulphur, Louisiana, met in special session at its temporary location located at 501 Willow Avenue in the Council Chambers, Sulphur, Louisiana, on August 24, 2026, immediately following the two special meetings with the first meeting starting at 5:30 p.m. after full compliance with the convening of said meeting with the following members present:

JAMES LEDOUX, Council Representative of District 1
TROY DARBY, Council Representative of District 2
DANIELLE MONCEAUX, Council Representative of District 3
JOSH BADEN, Council Representative of District 4
DANNY DIPETTA, Council Representative of District 5

After the meeting was called to order and the roll called with the above result, prayer and pledge was led by Mr. Baden.

The only item on the agenda is a resolution requesting an opinion from the Attorney General related to potential violations of public bid law by City of Sulphur, Louisiana. Mr. Baden read his letter to the Attorney General. Mr. DiPetta stated that he doesn't think just an opinion is needed. He thinks an investigation should be done first. Mr. DiPetta asked Mr. Baden what was the intent of the letter? Brandon Dever is only a tenant of 501 Willow. He feels it's a personal campaign against Mr. Dever. Mr. Baden then stated that no one on the Council has asked him to review all the public records request that he had to send to the Attorney General. Why is that? He also stated that in order to be reimbursed by FEMA it has to be an immovable building. Mayor Stutes stated that the information has already been sent to the Legislative Auditor. The District Attorney's office is on notice until the Legislative Auditor is done. If there are findings then it'll be sent to the District Attorney's office, and it will be brought before the Council. This information was also given to another Auditor weeks ago for a non-biased outlook. Mr. Loftin stated that the District Attorney's office only accepts charges from the Legislative

Auditor's office. Mr. DiPetta stated that there are 3 investigations on the same issue. Mr. Baden stated that he wanted to send his information to the Attorney General's office so the public doesn't have to pay for the investigation. He's also sending information to the Ethics Board. Mayor Stutes stated that they should let the Legislative Auditor do their part first. Fire Chief, Rusty Naquin, asked if the Legislative Auditor has no findings, then what? Mr. Baden stated, then it'll be over and the city can move forward.

Mr. DiPetta stated that he's not signing this document since it's one-sided and it's naming people and accusing them of things. Mrs. Monceaux stated that only one paragraph is accusing Mr. Dever of doing wrong. Mr. Loftin stated that the letter can be amended to take Mr. Dever's name out. Bill LeBlanc addressed the Council and stated that Sulphur is the laughing stock of this area and it can't continue like this. It's embarrassing. If someone did wrong, admit it and move on. Wendy Wingate stated that City Council shouldn't be in charge of the investigation. Is the Council here to fix the problem or protect friends. The bid law was clearly violated. In 2024 the Council had a special meeting to correct the date on a contract and they've been covering up for years. She also suggested that the Council bring back former Cade Cole and ask if we're getting 90% from FEMA since that's what he said in a prior meeting. Motion was then made by Mr. Darby seconded by Mr. LeDoux that 3 extra minutes be given to Ms. Wingate. Motion carried unanimously. Ms. Wingate then stated that when City Court donated $100,000 to fund the project that becomes public money. You can't split up projects to get what you want.

Sheila Broussard addressed the Council and stated that a multi-prong approach isn't a bad thing. The Attorney General's office takes a very long time. She also stated that if names are in the documents that shouldn't sway the AG's opinion on findings. It's disheartening for the Council to say they won't put their name on this resolution. Did the Mayor send the Legislative

Auditor all of Josh's information that was in his letter? A vote was then made by Mr. Darby seconded by Mr. LeDoux that Mrs. Broussard get 3 additional minutes to speak. Motion carried unanimously. Mrs. Broussard then stated that there can't be too many request sent to the AG's office. The more request the better.

Mike Granger addressed the Council and stated that no names should be mentioned in any of the letters, only mention their job title.

Lena McArthur asked where's the integrity of the city? Do one investigation, not 3 and don't do any name calling. Motion was then made by Mr. Darby seconded by Mrs. Monceaux that the following resolution be adopted to-wit:

RESOLUTION NO. 3710, M-C SERIES

RESOLUTION REQUESTING AN OPINION FROM THE ATTORNEY GENERAL RELATED TO POTENTIAL VIOLATIONS OF PUBLIC BID LAW BY CITY OF SULPHUR, LOUISIANA.

BE IT RESOLVED by the City Council of the City of Sulphur, Louisiana, the governing authority thereof, that they do hereby request an Attorney General's opinion related to potential violations of public bid law by City of Sulphur, Louisiana.

A vote was then called with the results as follows:

YEAS: Mr. LeDoux, Mr. Darby, Mrs. Monceaux, Mr. Baden
NAYS: Mr. DiPetta
ABSENT: None

And the said resolution was declared duly adopted on this 24th day of August, 2026.

ATTEST:

_____ _____

ARLENE BLANCHARD, Clerk DANNY DIPETTA, Chairman

There being no further business to come before the Council, the Chairman declared the meeting adjourned.

ATTEST:

_____	_____
ARLENE BLANCHARD, Clerk	DANNY DIPETTA, Chairman

8/24/26
6:50 P.M.